4. Pillars

When both the stalagmite and stalactite join together, it is known as pillar.

4.9 Wind

The wind is the main geomorphic agent in the arid region. Wind in arid region has greater speed which causes erosional and depositional activities in the desert. The landforms which are created by erosional and depositional activities of wind are called as Aeolian Landforms.

Action of the wind

The action of the wind is carried in the following ways;

1. **Deflation**: Removal of sand and dust particles by wind. It forms depression in the desert. When depression is filled with water, it is called as Oasis.
2. **Abrasion**: Action of wind in which sand particles carried by the wind strike against the rock.
3. **Attrition**: Sand particles carried by the wind striking each other is known as attrition.

4.9.1 Erosional Landforms of Wind

1. Deflation Hollows

When deflation causes a shallow depression by persistent movements of wind, they are called as deflation hollows.

2. Mushroom Rock

A mushroom rock, also called rock pedestal, or a pedestal rock, is a naturally occurring rock whose shape, as its name implies, resembles a mushroom.

In deserts, a greater amount of sand and rock particles are transported close to the ground by the winds which cause more



Figure 4.24 Oasis (Top)
Mushroom rock (Bottom)

erosion in the lower part of the rock than the top. These result in the formation of rock pillars shaped like a mushroom with narrow pillars with broad top surfaces.

3. Yardang

Yardangs are extensively grooved, fluted, pitted and irregular rock ridges or reliefs of about 1 to 10 meters high running parallel to the prevailing winds. They are caused by differential erosion. When the sand-laden wind corrades zones of softer or weaker rock between harder vertical ridges from old lake sediment where soft, consolidated rock and bedrock surfaces are eroded into alternating ridges and furrows. Large-scale yardangs are found in Egypt (near Kom Ombo, north of Lake Aswan).

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